

Thaddeus Grimsby

Character Dossier

Anxious but brave when it counts dockmaster of the Academy of Vell

Overview

Thaddeus Grimsby is a dockmaster living in the Academy of Vell. Thaddeus is 75 years old, originally from the Mirefold, and is known around the Hall of Echoes as anxious but brave when it counts. In conversation Thaddeus narrates their own actions under their breath.

Background

Thaddeus arrived in the Academy of Vell 16 years ago after leaving the Mirefold under circumstances Thaddeus describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Faculty of Applied Wonders; the second was the one that stuck. Today Thaddeus works as a dockmaster near the north observatory and is paid, when paid at all, in guilders.

Thaddeus learned the trade from Hamish Norwood, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Thaddeus's life is with Zora Grimsby, over a matter neither will explain. The person Thaddeus trusts most is Benedikt Ironside.

Current goal: to prove the old tunnels are real. Greatest fear: the far side of the Hall of Echoes.

Personality and speech

Temperament: anxious but brave when it counts.

Speech pattern: Thaddeus narrates their own actions under their breath.

Tells: when lying, Thaddeus mentions Cinder the parrot for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Thaddeus Grimsby
<i>Role</i>	dockmaster
<i>Home</i>	the Academy of Vell
<i>Hometown</i>	the Mirefold
<i>Age</i>	75
<i>Favourite dish</i>	midnight pear and blue cheese salad
<i>Pet</i>	Cinder, a parrot
<i>Lucky number</i>	920

<i>Workshop password</i>	ash-jade
<i>Mentor</i>	Hamish Norwood
<i>Rival</i>	Zora Grimsby
<i>Closest friend</i>	Benedikt Ironside

Secret

Thaddeus has a sibling nobody in the Academy of Vell knows about, living quietly in the Mirefold.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Thaddeus: I am the dockmaster. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Thaddeus: Midnight pear and blue cheese salad. Do not tell Zora I said so.

Visitor: Is Cinder yours?

Thaddeus: Cinder belongs to nobody. Cinder tolerates me. Lucky number is 920, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 14

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Thaddeus read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the Hall of Echoes. Thaddeus pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Thaddeus found a copper pipe half-buried near the Hall of Echoes and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Thaddeus moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks.

Entry 2, winter of year 14

A dispute over the census flared up between Thaddeus and a neighbour outside the north observatory; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Thaddeus closed early, walked to the candle library, and watched the lights come on. Thaddeus repaired the grain scale at the north observatory for Xavier, who paid in 30 guilders and a long story about the tariff on salt. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Thaddeus has a suspect and is probably right. At the north observatory, Thaddeus taught a newcomer how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 3, spring of year 14

Thaddeus spent the day counting stock at the candle library: 78 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Thaddeus and a neighbour outside the candle library; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Thaddeus was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the candle library to the north observatory without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 4, winter of year 14

Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the north observatory. Thaddeus pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the north observatory, Thaddeus taught a newcomer how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Thaddeus was hired to carry a sack of salt from the north observatory to the bell tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the north observatory. Thaddeus pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 5, summer of year 14

Rumours about the old tunnels reached the greenhouse cloisters. Thaddeus pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the greenhouse cloisters, Thaddeus taught a newcomer how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Thaddeus has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 6, summer of year 14

At the north observatory, Thaddeus taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Thaddeus repaired the ledger at the north observatory for Astrid, who paid in 4 guilders and a long story about the comet. Thaddeus closed early, walked to the Hall of Echoes, and watched the lights come on. Thaddeus won 36 guilders on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on supper. Thaddeus was hired to carry a sextant from the north observatory to the Hall of Echoes without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 7, spring of year 14

Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Thaddeus has a suspect and is probably right. The weather turned. Thaddeus moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the census. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Thaddeus and a neighbour outside the greenhouse cloisters; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Thaddeus won 72 guilders on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Orsolya came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Thaddeus said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 8, autumn of year 14

At the bell tower, Thaddeus taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Thaddeus found a iron kettle half-buried near the bell tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Thaddeus for the password to the workshop. Thaddeus laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 9, summer of year 15

Thaddeus spent the day counting stock at the Hall of Echoes: 21 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Thaddeus has a suspect and is probably right. Thaddeus won 3 guilders on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 10, summer of year 15

Thaddeus repaired the glass float at the greenhouse cloisters for Leocadia, who paid in 39 guilders and a long story about the singing at the docks. Thaddeus won 57 guilders on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Thaddeus found a cracked compass half-buried near the greenhouse cloisters and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Thaddeus found a cracked compass half-buried near the greenhouse cloisters and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Thaddeus spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 40 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short.

Entry 11, winter of year 15

Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Thaddeus has a suspect and is probably right. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.